

CAREER PATHS

Drilling engineers typically gain on-the-job responsibility quickly, moving from managing small projects to larger, multi-million dollar projects in a relatively short space of time. Training programs typically last for five years, and may include several changes of project and location.

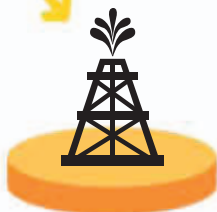
GRADUATE You can apply for graduate training programs with a degree in subjects such as geology, natural sciences, or petroleum engineering.



POSTGRADUATE You can improve your chances of entry into this career if you have a higher-level degree. You may also begin your career in a area of drilling.



DRILLING ENGINEER Since some firms operate overseas, you may need to be fluent in a foreign language. With experience you can choose a particular specialty, or seek promotion to senior roles.



SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to communicate with managers, engineers, and "rig hands" (manual workers).



Excellent team-working skills, and the willingness to live on rigs or in oilfield towns with colleagues.



Good interpersonal skills in order to work, often very closely, with people from all over the world.



Sharp analytical skills for effective decision-making about complex drilling operations.



The ability to draw on subject knowledge and technical expertise to solve complex problems.

DEEP WATER DRILLING ENGINEER Specializes in drilling wells under the sea floor from floating or fixed platforms. These wells may be for the exploration of new gas or oil reserves, or for extraction.



OIL COMPANY WELLSITE MANAGER Oversees every aspect of the drilling project from the wellsite, on behalf of the oil company.



DIRECTIONAL DRILLING ENGINEER Specializes in techniques that enable wells to be drilled at an angle, in order to extract more oil and gas.



HIGH-PRESSURE HIGH-TEMPERATURE DRILLING ENGINEER Drills wells under high pressures and temperatures, which require advanced drilling equipment and technique.



WELL TEST ENGINEER Conducts technical checks to ensure the optimum conditions for production of oil and gas. Also monitors operations, equipment, and staff to ensure health and safety standards are met.

